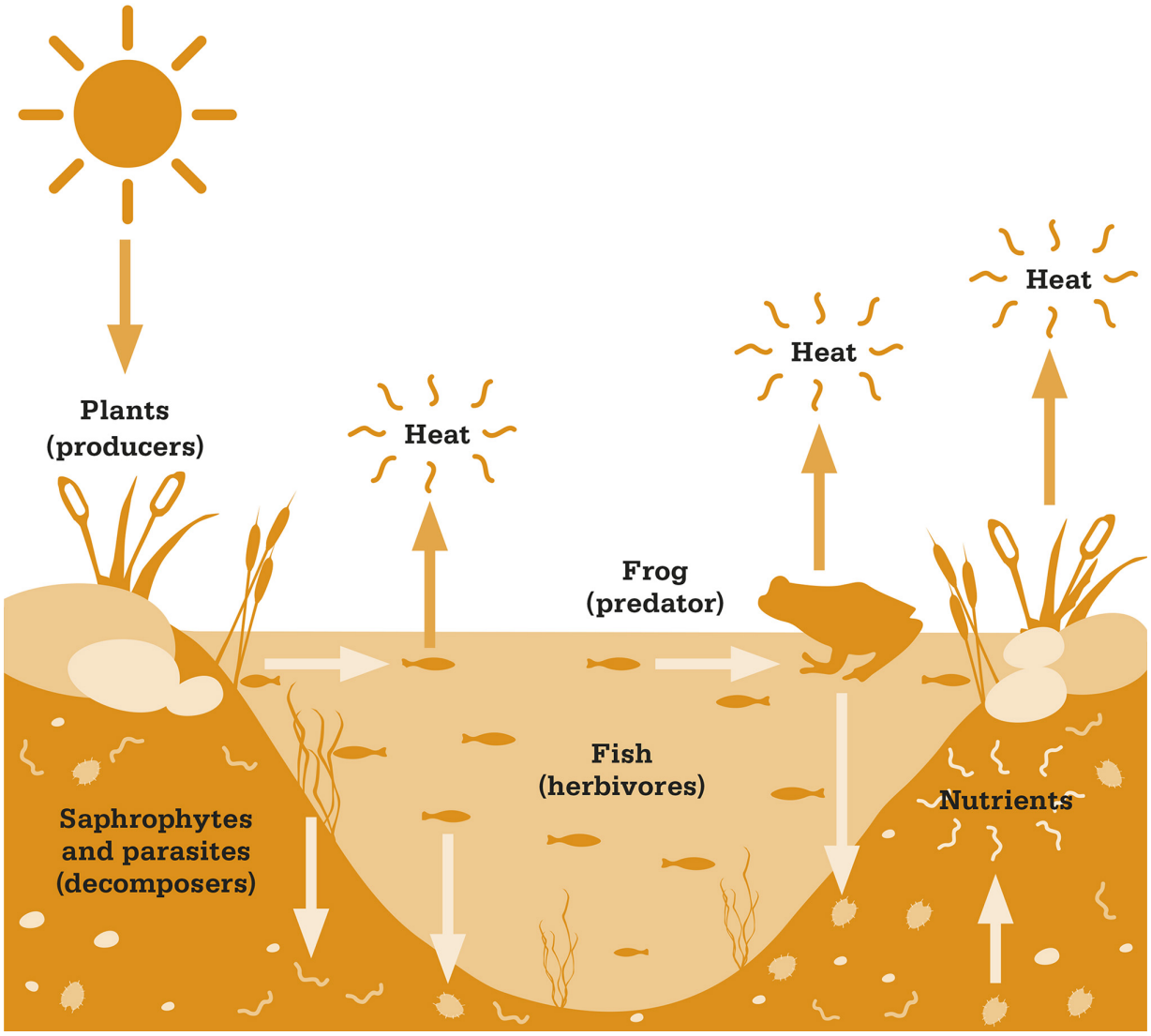
The dynamic transfer of energy



In this ecosystem, plants use the Sun's energy for photosynthesis. As shown by the pale arrows, this energy is passed on—to herbivores, who eat plants; to predators, who eat herbivores; and to saphrophytes, who take energy from decomposing remains and transfer nutrients to the soil. At each stage, some energy is lost as heat.

Read accessible description